DO YOU KNOW?

An extraction of tender leaves of papaya and herbal drink Nilavembu Kudineer is given to dengue patients. It is known to increase the blood platelet count. (Source: AYUSH)

Activity 2

Observe the mosquitoes that are active during the day time. Catch them using an insect net and observe their body and legs. What do you observe?. Why are cases of Dengue reported in large numbers during post-monsoon season?

22.6.4 Filaria

Filariasis is a major health problem in India. This disease is caused by **nematode** worm *Wuchereria bancrofti*. The adult worms are usually found in the lymphatic system of man. It is transmitted by the bite of infected *Culex* mosquito.

Incubation period of filarial worm is 8-16 months and the symptoms include acute infection, fever and inflammation in lymph glands. In chronic infection the main feature is **elephantiasis** which affects the legs, scrotum and the arms.

22.6.5 Mosquitoes – Prevention and Control

- Prevention of mosquito bites by using mosquito nets, mosquito screens, mosquito repellents and ointments.
- Elimination of breeding places by providing adequate sanitation, underground waste water disposable system and drainage of stagnant water.
- Collection of water in any uncovered container such as water tank, pots, flower pots, discarded tyres should be avoided.
- Control of mosquito larvae by spraying oil on stagnated water bodies.
- Adult mosquitoes can be killed by spraying insecticides.
- Application of citronella oil or eucalyptus oil on the exposed skin.

22.7 Diseases Transmitted by Animals

22.7.1 Swine Flu

Swine Flu first originated from pigs. It is caused by virus that affects pigs and has started infecting humans. The virus spreads through air. It affects the respiratory system.

Influeuza virus H1N1 has been identified as the cause of this disease. It is transmitted from person to person by inhalation or ingestion of droplets containing virus from people sneezing or coughing. Fever, cough, nasal secretion, fatigue, headache, sore throat, rashes in the body, body ache or pain, chills, nausea, vomiting and diarrhoea, and shortness of breath are the symptoms associated with the disease.

Prevention and Control

- Administration of nasal spray vaccine.
- Avoiding close contact with a person suffering from flu.
- Intake of water and fruit juices will help prevent dehydration.
- Plenty of rest will help the body to fight infection.
- Always wash hands and practice good hygiene.

More to Know

Swine flu first surfaced in April 2009 and affected millions of people. Then in June 2009 it was declared a pandemic by the World Health Organization (WHO). In 2015, India reportedly had over 31,000 people infected and 1,900 resulting deaths.

22.7.2 Avian Influenza

Avian influenza is a contagious bird disease caused by viruses. Birds that can carry and spread avian influenza virus include poultry (chickens, turkeys or ducks), wild birds and pet birds.

It is caused by **Influenza Virus H5N1.** The incubation period of the virus is 2-7 days. People who have close contact with infected birds or

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